

ISMUN 4.0

BACKGROUND GUIDE



JOINT CRISIS COMMITTEE:

TAIWANESE CABINET

Agenda: Crisis Management of Taiwan-Chinese
Conflict

Simulation Year: 2028

LETTER FROM THE EXECUTIVE BOARD

Dear Delegates,

In a crisis, there is rarely a perfect decision, only the decision that needs to be made. This committee will test your ability to think quickly, adapt to changing situations, and make choices when there is no obvious answer. The course of the crisis will depend on the decisions you make and how well you respond to what comes your way.

On behalf of the Executive Board, we warmly welcome all delegates and congratulate you on being a part of the first edition of JCC at the fourth edition of ISMUN. We look forward to two days filled with engaging debates, unexpected developments, and discussions that will challenge you to think beyond the obvious.

This background guide is intended to give you a foundation for your preparation and help you understand the key aspects of the agenda. However, we strongly encourage you to explore beyond what has been provided here. Research the history, understand the interests of the different stakeholders, and look into the wider issues connected to the crisis. The more you understand the situation, the better you will be able to respond when things take an unexpected turn.

At the same time, we do not want preparation to limit your spontaneity. A JCC is not about coming into the room with every speech already planned. It is about listening, reacting, negotiating, and making decisions as the situation develops. We encourage you to bring forward creative ideas, question existing approaches, and come up with solutions that are practical as well as original.

We also encourage every delegate to participate with confidence. Do not hesitate to challenge an argument, defend your position, or introduce a completely different perspective. Some of the most interesting moments in committee come from delegates who are willing to take risks and think outside the conventional approach.

Most importantly, remember to enjoy the experience. A JCC can be unpredictable, fast-paced, and sometimes completely different from what you expected—and that is what makes it exciting. Embrace the uncertainty, think on your feet, and make the most of every crisis that comes your way.

We look forward to seeing your ideas, decisions, and strategies shape the course of the committee.

Regards,

The Executive Board

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1. THE JOINT CRISIS COMMITTEE

(JCC) AN INTRODUCTION

What is a Joint Crisis Committee?

It's like a giant game of strategy between two opposing executive rooms reacting in real time to the same unfolding emergency. In a normal Model United Nations committee, delegates sit together in one large committee, debate for a few days, and write one paper. A Joint Crisis Committee, or JCC, splits delegates into two different rooms that are in competition with each other, called Cabinets.

1. Taiwanese Cabinet (Republic of China)

Taipei's national leadership: President, defence officials, heads of intelligence, foreign diplomats, economic ministers, regional partner liaisons (USA, Japan, Australia, India). Your objective is to defend Taiwan's democracy, save civilian lives, keep trade flowing and avoid escalation to World War III.

2. Chinese State Council (PRC)

Central government in Beijing . Central Military Commission . Ministry of Foreign Affairs . Ministry of State Security . Economic planners . Their task is to support Beijing's sovereignty claim over Taiwan, counter foreign interference and apply growing political and military pressure.

Normal MUN vs. Joint Crisis Committee: Key Differences

Feature	Standard UN Assembly	Joint Crisis Committee (JCC)
Pace & Timing	Deliberate, formal speeches; fixed rules of debate.	Fast, fluid, and urgent; changes every 30 minutes.

Core Objective	Pass a compromise resolution by broad consensus.	Solve rolling crises; execute orders; counter the rival cabinet.
Information Flow	Static agenda known weeks before the conference.	Dynamic "Crisis Updates" delivered live by Crisis Directors.
Delegate Power	Delegates vote on speeches and draft resolutions.	Portfolios deploy state resources, sign orders, and send chits.

2. INTRODUCTION TO THE AGENDA: **THE TAIWAN STRAIT CONFLICT**

At first glance, the Taiwan Strait dispute appears to be a row between two governments over an ocean corridor only 160 kilometres (100 miles) wide. In fact, it is one of Earth's most important geopolitical crossroads. To get a sense of why this crisis is important for middle schoolers, world leaders, and global business executives, we need to understand the political fight at the heart of it, the global stakes, and key terms

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The Central Political Dispute

The People's Republic of China (PRC) claims Taiwan as an inseparable province that must be reunified with the mainland and has not ruled out the use of force. In contrast, the Republic of China (ROC / Taiwan) is a self-governing democracy with its own constitution, elected president, legal system, passport, and military, and insists that only its 23.5 million residents should decide its future .

Why It's Not "China vs. Taiwan"

United States: Required under Taiwan Relations Act to provide defensive arms.

Japan: Located just 110 km (68 miles) from Taiwan, Yonaguni Island lies in a strait that carries vital energy imports. Australia: Supports freedom of navigation in Indo-Pacific waters.

India: Pacific shipping is open; balances China by Himalayan border.

Important

Terms Every Delegate Should Know

PRC vs. ROC PRC = People's Republic of China (Beijing). ROC = Republic of China, the official constitutional name of Taiwan, (Taipei).

PLA & PLAN PLA = People's Liberation Army (Chinese military). PLAN = Navy of the People's Liberation Army

ADIZ – Air Defence Identification Zone International airspace in which a nation observes inbound aircraft for security purposes. (Non-sovereign territorial airspace).

Median Line: An unofficial line down the middle of the Taiwan Strait that kept the two militaries apart for decades.

Status Quo The existing peace: Taiwan does not declare de jure independence and China does not invade.

Cross-Strait Relations The political, economic, cultural and diplomatic relations between Beijing and Taipei.

Deterrence : Having enough defensive power to persuade a would-be adversary that an attack would be too costly .

Blockade vs. Quarantine A blockade is a military act of war that cuts all traffic . A quarantine halts and inspects cargo on coast guard ships under civil inspection rules.

VITAL CLARIFICATION: "ONE-CHINA PRINCIPLE" VS. "ONE-CHINA POLICY"

These two words are very similar but mean very different things:

- Beijing's "One-China Principle": Claims that there is only one China, that Taiwan is an inalienable part of China, and that the PRC is the only legitimate government of all China.
- The United States "One-China Policy": Recognises Beijing as the sole legitimate government of China and accepts the Chinese position that Taiwan is part of China but does not formally endorse Beijing's claim of sovereignty over Taiwan. It says differences between the two sides of the Taiwan Strait must be settled peacefully

3. HISTORICAL BACKGROUND: KEY TURNING POINTS (1949–2026)

Year / Era	Historical Milestone	Why It Matters to Our 2028 Cabinet
1949	The Chinese Civil War concludes on the mainland. Mao Zedong establishes the PRC in Beijing. Chiang Kai-shek relocates the ROC government to Taiwan.	Created the modern political division: two rival governments governing two separate geographic territories.
1954 – 1958	First & Second Taiwan Strait Crises: Heavy PLA artillery bombardments strike Taiwan's frontline islands of Kinmen and Matsu.	Prompted the 1954 US-ROC Mutual Defense Treaty and established the strategic vulnerability of outlying frontline islands.
1971	UN General Assembly Resolution 2758: The UN recognizes the PRC as China's sole legitimate representative to the UN.	The ROC lost its UN seat. Today, Taiwan is excluded from international bodies like the WHO and ICAO despite governing 23.5 million people.
1979	The US formally normalizes diplomatic relations with Beijing, severing official ties with Taipei. The US Congress passes the Taiwan Relations Act (TRA) .	The TRA legally obligates the US to provide Taiwan with arms of a defensive character and to maintain the US capacity to resist coercion.

1995 – 1996	Third Taiwan Strait Crisis: China conducts missile tests near Keelung and Kaohsiung ports. US President Clinton deploys two aircraft carrier battle groups.	Showcased US willingness to intervene militarily and accelerated PLA naval and missile modernization to counter US naval power.
1996	Taiwan holds its first direct, democratic presidential election; Lee Teng-hui is elected.	Transformed Taiwan into an open, multiparty democracy, deepening the identity of its citizens as distinct from authoritarian governance.
2016 – 2020	Tsai Ing-wen is elected President. Beijing freezes high-level communication. The 2019 Hong Kong crackdown discredits the "One Country, Two Systems" framework in Taiwan.	Official government-to-government hotlines between Taipei and Beijing were severed, increasing the danger of miscalculation during the crisis.
August 2022	US House Speaker Nancy Pelosi visits Taipei. The PLA responds with live-fire drills surrounding Taiwan and routinely crosses the median line.	Dismantled the historical buffer zone of the Strait Median Line; normalized high-intensity Chinese military operations near Taiwan's coast.
2024	Lai Ching-te is inaugurated as President. Beijing conducts large-scale encirclement exercises named JOINT SWORD-2024A (May) and 2024B (October).	Practiced simulated blockade scenarios against Taiwan's primary commercial ports and demonstrated rapid joint-force mobilization.

2025 – 2026	The PLA normalizes "grey-zone" operations: Coast Guard patrols into Taiwan's restricted waters, drone flights, and joint drills including STRAIT THUNDER-2025A .	Depletes Taiwanese military readiness through continuous alert cycles without crossing the threshold into full-scale war.
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Imperial and Colonial Background

The historical significance of Taiwan is connected to the wider history of China and East Asia. During the nineteenth century, Qing China experienced increasing foreign intervention and territorial pressure. The Opium Wars and subsequent unequal treaties weakened Qing sovereignty and contributed to what Chinese historical narratives describe as the "Century of Humiliation." The First Sino-Japanese War of 1894–95 further altered the regional balance.

Following China's defeat, Taiwan was ceded to Japan in 1895. Japanese rule lasted until the end of the Second World War.

These historical experiences later became important to Chinese nationalist narratives surrounding sovereignty and territorial integrity.

The Chinese Civil War

The modern political division emerged primarily from the Chinese Civil War. The Chinese Communist Party (CCP) and the Kuomintang (KMT) had previously cooperated during parts of the struggle against foreign invasion, but their relationship deteriorated substantially during the late 1920s. After years of conflict, the CCP under Mao Zedong emerged victorious on the mainland in 1949.

On 1 October 1949, the People's Republic of China was established in Beijing. The ROC government subsequently relocated to Taiwan.

The two governments initially continued to claim that they represented China as a whole. Thus, the division was not originally understood by either side simply as the creation of two independent states. This historical foundation remains central to China's official position today. Chinese government documents

describe the Taiwan question due to the Chinese Civil War and argue that the establishment of the PRC represented a change of government within one China rather than the creation of a separate Chinese state.

The Cold War and the First Taiwan Strait Crises

The emerging division became internationalised during the Cold War.

The Korean War in 1950 increased American involvement in East Asian security. The United States deployed naval forces around Taiwan, while Beijing viewed American involvement as external interference preventing reunification.

The First Taiwan Strait Crisis began in 1954 when conflict developed around offshore islands controlled by the ROC, particularly Kinmen and Matsu. A second crisis followed in 1958.

These crises demonstrated that the Taiwan question could rapidly involve major powers and potentially escalate beyond the immediate geographical area.

They also established a recurring pattern:

political pressure → military signalling → external intervention → heightened risk of escalation.

International Representation and Resolution 2758

For much of the early Cold War, the ROC government retained China's seat at the United Nations.

However, international recognition gradually shifted towards the PRC as more states recognised Beijing as the government representing China.

In October 1971, the UN General Assembly adopted Resolution 2758, restoring the PRC's lawful rights in the United Nations and recognising the representatives of its government as the legitimate representatives of China.

The resolution fundamentally changed Taiwan's position within the international system.

Beijing interprets Resolution 2758 as confirming the One-China Principle and the PRC's representation of China, including Taiwan. Other governments and

legal scholars have debated the extent to which the resolution itself determines Taiwan's sovereignty or international legal status.

US-China Normalisation

The United States formally recognised the PRC in 1979.

The US simultaneously maintained unofficial relations with Taiwan and established the Taiwan Relations Act.

This created a complicated strategic structure in which Washington recognised Beijing diplomatically while continuing substantial unofficial political, economic and security relations with Taiwan.

The resulting ambiguity became a major component of deterrence in the Strait.

For Beijing, American involvement remains closely connected to the question of reunification and foreign interference.

For Washington, Taiwan has remained important to regional stability and the wider balance of power in the Western Pacific.

Democratisation of Taiwan

One of the most significant developments after the Cold War was Taiwan's political transformation.

Martial law was lifted in 1987. Opposition political activity expanded, press restrictions decreased and democratic institutions developed.

Taiwan subsequently held increasingly competitive elections, culminating in its first direct presidential election in 1996.

This transformation affected the political nature of the cross-Strait dispute. The population living on Taiwan increasingly became an important political actor in determining the island's future.

The study guide notes that democratic development contributed to a distinct Taiwanese identity and changed the political calculations surrounding reunification.

The Third Taiwan Strait Crisis

The Third Taiwan Strait Crisis occurred during 1995–96.

Taiwanese President Lee Teng-hui's visit to the United States was interpreted by Beijing as challenging the existing political framework. China conducted missile tests and large-scale military exercises around Taiwan.

The crisis coincided with Taiwan's first direct presidential election.

The United States responded by deploying two aircraft carrier battle groups to the region. The crisis ultimately ended without direct war.

The episode had long-term consequences.

China accelerated military modernisation, Taiwan strengthened its defence capabilities and Washington demonstrated that a Taiwan crisis could generate direct American military involvement.

Cross-Strait Economic Integration

Despite political tensions, economic links between mainland China and Taiwan expanded substantially after the 1990s.

Trade, investment and business relationships created significant economic interdependence.

This produced an important contradiction:

The same relationship could simultaneously reduce incentives for conflict and create strategic vulnerabilities.

Economic integration could provide incentives for stability, but it could also become a source of leverage during a crisis.

Recent Escalation

Political tensions increased significantly during the 2020s.

Taiwan's domestic politics, US-China strategic competition and increasingly frequent Chinese military activity around Taiwan contributed to a more difficult security environment.

The 2022 visit of US House Speaker Nancy Pelosi to Taiwan was followed by large-scale Chinese military exercises around the island. The episode demonstrated how a political event could rapidly generate military consequences.

The committee study guide presents the current environment as one characterised by repeated military exercises, political mistrust, competing interpretations of sovereignty and limited diplomatic space.

The simulation begins in 2028, but delegates should not assume that every future development is predetermined. The crisis is intentionally designed to evolve through committee action.

4. RECENT DEVELOPMENTS & MODERN SECURITY ENVIRONMENT

The military and economic balance around Taiwan has shifted dramatically in recent years. Beijing has moved from symbolic protests to practical dress rehearsals for economic isolation, blockades and rapid precision strikes.

Major Recent Exercises & Tactics

Exercise / Operation	Observed Tactical Activity	Strategic Impact on Taiwan
JOINT SWORD-2024A (May 2024, Eastern Theater)	Simulated precision missile strikes against high-value targets; combined navy-air force patrols encircling Taiwan.	Tested Taiwan's early-warning radars and simulated the denial of foreign naval intervention from the Pacific.
JOINT SWORD-2024B (October 2024, 13-Hour Drill)	Focused explicitly on "key port blockade and seizure of maritime control" near Keelung and Kaohsiung.	Demonstrated that the PLA can mobilize strike groups within hours without lengthy, detectable build-ups.
STRAIT THUNDER-2025A (Spring 2025 Maneuvers)	Integrated China Coast Guard (CCG) vessels to conduct simulated "law-enforcement inspections" of commercial ships.	Practiced executing a civilian "quarantine" rather than a formal military blockade, complicating international legal responses.

Maritime & Airspace Encroachment

Taiwan's Ministry of National Defence (MND) reports that PLA fighter jets, bombers and surveillance drones cross the median line and enter Taiwan's

southwestern and eastern ADIZ almost daily. It wears out Taiwanese pilots, consumes costly jet fuel and stresses maintenance crews.

Cyber Cognitive and subsea Threats

Taiwan is subject to tens of millions of cyberattacks on government and financial institutions every month. Commercial Chinese sand-dredgers and cargo vessels have also repeatedly severed undersea fiber-optic communications cables linking Matsu to Taiwan, testing civilian resilience.

What's Changed Recently?

The biggest threat is no longer just a sudden amphibious invasion across the beaches. The modern threat is a strangulation campaign: using naval cordons, coast guard inspections, cyber disruption, and missile deterrence to cut Taiwan off from energy and food imports without firing a single artillery shell.

5. CASE STUDY: TAIWAN STRAIT

CRISIS, AUGUST 2022

The best recent template for how an unanticipated political event can generate an instant regional emergency is the crisis that followed US House Speaker Nancy Pelosi's visit to Taipei in August 2022.

1. What happened and why

Speaker Pelosi's visit to Taipei, Aug. 2-3, 2022, was to reaffirm US support for Taiwan's democracy. China's capital saw the visit as a serious breach of diplomatic protocol and sovereignty that was simply unacceptable.

2. Chinese Military Response

The PLA announced six exclusion zones around Taiwan for live-fire drills, launched 11 ballistic missiles (several over-flying Taipei into the Pacific) and sent dozens of warships across the median line.

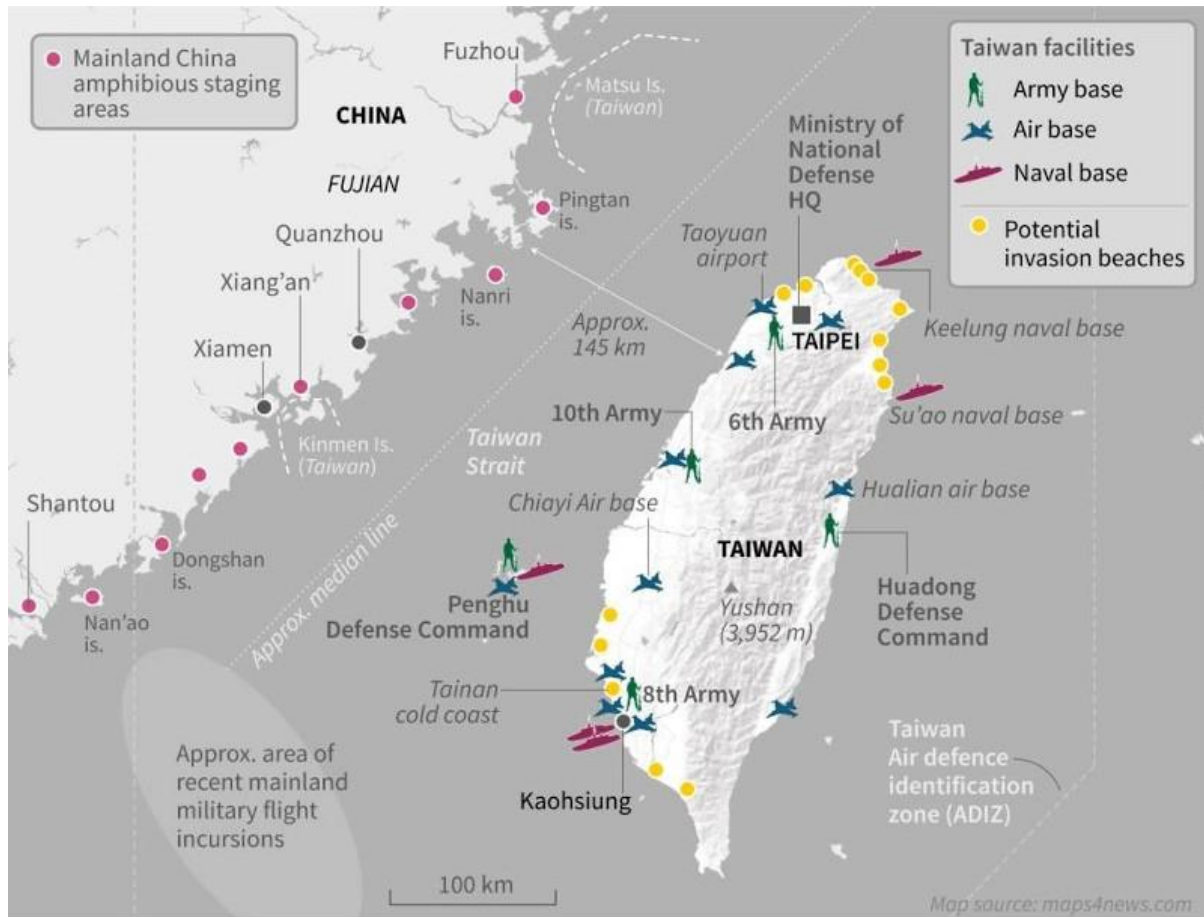
3. Taiwan's Defence Limitation

Taiwan tracked all missile trajectories and deployed coastal missile units, but did not shoot down high-altitude missiles in space, preventing the crisis from escalating into open war."

4. International and Economic Fallout

Five Chinese missiles hit Japan's Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ). Millions of dollars and hundreds of commercial passenger flights and container ships had to be diverted around missile hazard boxes.

6. WHY THE TAIWAN STRAIT MATTERS TO THE WORLD



1. The Busiest Highway in the World

Almost 50% of the world's container ship fleet passes through the Taiwan Strait each year. It links the industrial powerhouses of China, Japan and South Korea with Europe, the Middle East and the Americas. The closure of the Strait would cause a global logistics logjam worse than the 2021 Suez Canal blockage.

2. The “Silicon Shield”

Taiwan makes over 60% of the world's semiconductors, and over 90% of the world's most advanced microchips (sub-5 nanometre chips made by TSMC). These chips are the tiny brains of smartphones, medical pacemakers, automotive engines, jet airliners and artificial intelligence data centers.

Estimated \$10 Trillion Impact

A full analysis by Bloomberg Economics estimated that a military blockade or conflict in the Taiwan Strait would take around \$10 Trillion out of the global economy, or about 10% of total world GDP.

Regional Security Architecture:

For Japan and South Korea, more than 80% of imported crude oil passes through adjacent waters. For Australia and India, an authoritarian breakthrough beyond the First Island Chain fundamentally changes open maritime commerce across the Indo-Pacific.

7. PORTFOLIO GUIDE: TAIWANESE **CABINET**

1. President of the Republic of China (Taiwan) (Head of State & Commander-in-Chief) VERIFIED 2026: LAI CHING-TE

Mandate Executive Yuan & National Security Council Leadership • 2028
Simulation Portfolio

Core Job: Top constitutional responsibility for national security, defence, diplomacy and civil protection. Convenes cabinet crisis meetings and addresses the public.

Authorises military mobilisation Authorises emergency legislation Signs Cabinet Directives Coordinates Powers & Influence Issues presidential executive orders

Cabinet focus: To calm the public, to preserve democratic institutions, to coordinate ministries and to reassure international partners.

* **Restrictions** : Must maintain democratic constitution ; can not unilaterally declare offensive war without incurring domestic and international backlash .

2. National Security Bureau (NSB) Director-General VERIFIED 2026: TSAI MING-YEN

Mandate: National Intelligence Community Coordination and Threat Assessment

Key Position: Taiwan's chief intelligence official. Gathers and analyses satellite tracking, signals intelligence, cyber intrusion warnings, and cross-strait military mobilisation.

Powers & Influence: Files private intelligence reports, Determines if Chinese military movements are feints or real attacks, Runs counter-espionage.

Cabinet Priority: Protecting government communications, countering adversary disinformation campaigns, early warning alerts.

Limitations: advisory and intelligence only; does not in itself command infantry or naval forces.

3. NSA United States National Security Advisor US WHITE HOUSE EXECUTIVE OFFICE

Mandate: Chief National Security Adviser to the President of the United States

Core Job: The highest level of US security policy in the cabinet room. Coordinates U.S. response under the Taiwan Relations Act

Powers & Influence: Recommends US military posture (7th Fleet, carrier strike groups), shares satellite data, coordinates joint logistics, directs diplomatic pressure on Beijing.

Cabinet Focus: Preventing unprovoked aggression, keeping open regional shipping, and avoiding accidental nuclear escalation.

Limitations: Requires US Presidential approval; must take US public opinion into account and not start WW3.

4. Indian National Security Advisor (NSA)AJIT DOVAL VERIFIED 2026

Mandate: Prime Minister's Office & National Security Council Secretariat (India)

Core Job: To protect Indian strategic interests in the wider Indo-Pacific and secure commercial maritime shipping lanes through the Indian Ocean.

Powers & Influence: Exercises strategic maritime influence over approaches to the Malacca Strait; coordinates diplomatic statements; monitors pressure along northern Himalayan border.

Cabinet Focus: Strategic autonomy, securing of trade routes, checking unilateral coercive expansion, and promoting de-escalation.

Limitations: No formal military alliances, no combat troops in the Taiwan Strait, focus on naval diplomacy, supply-chain security.

5. VERIFIED 2026: WELLINGTON KOO Minister of National Defence (MND) Taiwan

Mandate: Coordination of Civilian Defence Policy Leadership and Readiness

Main job: Oversees Taiwan's military (Army, Navy, Air Force), defence budget, ammo stockpiles, missile reserves, civil defence forces.

Powers & Influence: Changes military readiness alerts, deploys mobile anti-ship missile batteries, calls up reserves, supervises air defence systems.

Cabinet Focus: Exhibit strong defensive deterrence, but don't give Beijing a pretext to claim "Taiwan fired first."

6. Japanese Defence Minister MINISTRY OF DEFENCE (MOD, TOKYO)

Mandate: Self-defence Force (JSDF) & Southwest Islands Security

Core Job: Secure Japanese sovereign territory, including Okinawa, Miyako and Yonaguni (just 110 km from Taiwan's coast).

Powers & Influence: Authorises JSDF maritime surveillance patrols, missile defence readiness, evacuation planning for civilians; coordinates with US Forces Japan.

Cabinet Focus: Securing Japan's waters and airspace, protecting sea lines of communication, and ensuring regional stability.

Limitations: Constrained by Article 9 of Japan's Constitution (strictly defensive); actions must meet domestic legal thresholds.

7. RICHARD MARLES Australian Minister for Defence VERIFIED 2026

Mandate: ADF and Indo-Pacific security.

Core Job: Guarantees freedom of navigation in the South Pacific and Indian Ocean; works with the US and regional partners through the ANZUS and AUKUS agreements.

Powers & Influence Long-range maritime patrol aircraft (P-8A Poseidon), logistics, multilateral diplomatic pressure.

Cabinet focus on a rules-based maritime order, supply-chain resilience and support for de-escalation Constraints: Australian warships are far away from Taiwan Strait; stresses diplomatic and multilateral deterrence.

8. Commander of the Taiwanese Navy VERIFIED 2026 TANG HUA ROC Navy Headquarters • Maritime Defence & Port Security Mandate

Core Job: Operational command of Taiwan's destroyers, frigates, missile corvettes, submarines and coastal anti-ship missile battalions.

Powers & Influence : Allows for defensive naval escort of merchant ships, deployment of sea-mine layers, tracking of PLA warships, protection of ports such as Kaohsiung.

Cabinet Focus Keeping commercial shipping lanes open and breaking maritime cordons or quarantines.

Limitations: respond to civilian orders from MND and the President; strictly defensive posture under rules of Involvement.

9. Taiwanese Minister of Foreign Affairs (MOFA) VERIFIED 2026: CHIA-LUNG LIN

Mandate: International Diplomacy and Consular Affairs, Global Coalition Building

Core Job: International spokesman for Taiwan. Talks to foreign embassies, lobbies democratic parliaments, appeals to international organisations.

Powers & Influence Files formal diplomatic protests. Prepares joint statements with allied nations. Organises humanitarian assistance routes.

Cabinet Focus: Preventing diplomatic isolation, garnering international condemnation of coercive measures, developing economic coalition backing.

Limitations: Not a war maker, relies on diplomatic persuasion, international law, shared democratic values

10. Taiwanese Minister of Economic Affairs (MOEA) VERIFIED 2026 J.W. KUO

Responsibility: Energy Security, Critical Infrastructure, Trade & Semiconductor Policy

Core job: Protects Taiwan's domestic economy, manages strategic oil and gas reserves, protects semiconductor facilities (TSMC), and prevents economic panic.

P & I : Implements fuel rationing policy . Guides trade diversion . Collaborates with global chip buyers . Safeguards power plants .

Focus of the cabinet: economic resilience, protection of the “silicon shield,” preserving civilian electricity, and neutralising trade embargoes.

Limitations: Vulnerable to import cut-offs (Taiwan imports 97% of its energy, natural gas reserves typically last 10-14 days).

8. PRE-COMMITTEE CRISIS UPDATES

Timeframe	Incident / Intelligence Report	Cabinet Implication & Tension Point
T-30 Days	Taiwan's Legislative Yuan debates enhanced security standards for subsea communication cables and foreign port investments. Beijing denounces the bill as "disguised separatism."	Political rhetoric escalates across state media; PRC warns of "resolute countermeasures."
T-14 Days	The United States and international partners announce a joint maritime safety initiative in the Western Pacific, including radar sharing with regional democracies.	Beijing terms the initiative an "illegal intervention in domestic affairs" and mobilizes Coast Guard and naval flotillas.
T-7 Days	China's Maritime Safety Administration (MSA) issues a notice establishing "Enhanced Maritime Customs Inspection Zones" covering major approaches to the Taiwan Strait.	Commercial insurance rates for cargo ships heading to Taiwan jump 250%; several shipping carriers pause transits.
T-3 Days	Two Chinese Coast Guard vessels attempt to board and inspect an unflagged commercial bulk carrier delivering liquefied natural gas (LNG) 40 nautical miles off Kaohsiung.	Taiwan Coast Guard cutters arrive and interpose between the vessels. Standoff ensues without gunfire.

**T-0
(Today)**

Committee Commences: Radar sensors detect an unprecedented surge of over 60 PLA aircraft crossing the median line, while naval task forces position north and south of Taiwan.

**The Crisis Director
will deliver the
opening live update
as the session begins!**

9. HOW A JOINT CRISIS COMMITTEE OPERATES

1. Orders in Council (Full Cabinet)

And the live update will begin with the Crisis Director as the session starts! A Directive is the formal collective action of the entire Taiwanese Government. It talks about major actions by the state, like upping the national military preparedness, issuing an energy emergency or starting a diplomatic effort. It has to be sponsored and debated and passed by a majority of the cabinet, and signed by the president.

2. Ministry Actions (Action Orders)

An Action Order is a precise operational instruction, issued by one or two ministries within their exact legal powers. For example, the Navy Commander ordering the coastal corvettes to escort a cargo ship. Or the Minister of Economic Affairs releasing 500,000 barrels of emergency fuel. “Full cabinet vote is not required for this.

3. Personal Crisis Notes (Substantive Chits)

A Substantive Chit is a private note written by a single Delegate and given directly to Crisis Staff. You use chits to do confidential business: requesting secret intelligence briefings, deploying ministry assets quietly, opening back-channel diplomatic discussions, or checking technical infrastructure capabilities.

Comparison of JCC Action Documents

Document Type	Who Can Author?	Approval Required?	Best Used For
Cabinet Directive	Any delegate(s); requires multiple sponsors.	Majority Cabinet Vote & Presidential Assent.	Major national policy, military mobilization, nationwide civil defense.

Action Order	Specific portfolio holder (e.g., Defense, Economy).	Authorized by the respective Minister.	Immediate department-level operations within legal portfolio mandate.
Substantive Chit	Individual delegate.	Backroom Crisis Director evaluation.	Private intelligence requests, covert preparations, discrete diplomacy.

Golden Rules for Writing Quality Directives

- 1. Be Specific:** Do not just write "protect the ports." Specify *which* ships, *what* radar frequencies, and *under what* rules of engagement.
- 2. Use Realistic Resources:** Taiwan cannot build 50 new submarines in an afternoon. Use assets that actually exist.
- 3. Identify Risks:** Always ask: "*What will Beijing do when they see this order?*" Plan for their response.

10. DIRECTIVE (TEMPLATES)

Directives are condensed Draft Resolutions for each Crisis Break, and remnants of unsolved updates or developments should ideally be addressed in subsequent directives. Directives are the main way that the committee as a whole addresses Crisis Updates and are the principal piece of formal paperwork for us. Before the next Crisis Break, delegates should ideally come up with a comprehensive directive addressing all issues posed by the crisis updates. Since there are never any real solutions, only trade-offs, it is for the House to determine the trade-offs. However, this is highly idealistic, and the Executive Board will leave it to the committee to determine how frequently they wish to address updates using directives. Directives do not have to be very long and can be the length of just a few operative clauses, which attempt to quickly solve specific issues that are present at hand in committee.

TEMPLATE 1: CABINET DIRECTIVE

DIRECTIVE TITLE: Operation Iron Shield (Strategic Port Defense)

SUBMITTED BY: Minister of National Defense, Navy Commander, Minister of Economic Affairs

SITUATION SUMMARY: PLA naval vessels have established a cordon 30nm from Kaohsiung.

STRATEGIC OBJECTIVE: Re-open commercial shipping lane to ensure energy imports without initiating combat.

OPERATIONAL MEASURES:

1. Deploy Coast Guard cutters to lead commercial LNG tankers through recognized safe sea lanes.
2. Station Navy corvettes at a 15nm defensive perimeter with coastal radar tracking enabled.

3. Establish a live video feed to broadcast all interactions to international maritime observers.

RESOURCES REQUIRED: 4 Coast Guard patrol vessels, 2 Tuo Chiang-class corvettes, Kaohsiung Port Authority.

EXPECTED OUTCOME: Safely dock LNG cargo while deterring boarding actions through public transparency.

TEMPLATE 2: PORTFOLIO ACTION ORDER

ACTION ORDER: MOEA-2028-04

TO: Bureau of Energy, Taiwan Power Company (Taipower), Crisis Staff

FROM: Minister of Economic Affairs

SUBJECT: Phase 1 National Energy Conservation & Reserve Allocation

MANDATE ACTION: Release 10% of strategic petroleum reserves to critical power generators. Mandate non-essential industrial energy cuts during peak hours to preserve LNG stockpiles for 18 days.

RESOURCES: National Petroleum Strategic Reserve Facilities, Taipower dispatch center.

POTENTIAL RISK: Temporary 4% dip in non-essential manufacturing output; public market unease.

SIGNATURE: [Minister of Economic Affairs]

TEMPLATE 3: SUBSTANTIVE CRISIS CHIT

TO: Crisis Staff (Intelligence & Maritime Desk)

FROM: Director-General, National Security Bureau (NSB)

CLASSIFICATION: TOP SECRET // CABINET EYES ONLY

MESSAGE: Request immediate satellite confirmation regarding the true loading manifests of Chinese maritime militia vessels off Pratas Island.

INFORMATION REQUESTED: Are these vessels carrying armed personnel and water cannons, or are they standard civilian trawlers acting as visual pickets?

DISCRETE ACTION: Task two high-altitude maritime reconnaissance drones to photograph deck equipment from international airspace.

PRIORITY: HIGH (Requires response within 20 minutes for Cabinet briefing)

11. CRITICAL MAPS TO MEMORISE

DELEGATE PREPARATION

CHECKLIST & 15 CRISIS QUESTIONS

Taiwan Strait (Median Line, ports of Keelung and Kaohsiung).

- Outer Islands (Kinmen, Matsu, Penghu, Pratas).
- East China Sea (Yonaguni Island, Okinawa Arc)
- South China Sea & Bashi Channel (Luzon Strait)

Important Concepts Index

- Quarantine vs. Blockade (Civil vs. Military) .
- Geography of the First Island Chain.
- Taiwan Relations Act (TRA) requirement.
- Subsea Internet Cables & Energy Vulnerabilities.

15 Questions Every Delegate Must Know How to Answer in a Crisis

1. What if commercial cargo ships were denied access to the Strait?

Approach: Government subsidised maritime insurance and Navy escorts.

2. What if the Chinese Coast Guard attempts to board?

Approach: Taiwan Coast Guard cutters between ships. Film everything. Don't shoot first. 3. What happens when undersea internet cables are cut? 4. How can Taiwan cooperate with international partners?

Approach: Hold simultaneous press conferences that emphasise international law and UNCLOS. 5. What if the grocery stores panic hoard domestically?

Approach: Presidential address to reassure public; mobilise municipal distribution reserves.

6. What role can India actually play?

Approach: Increase maritime patrols in the Malacca Strait and choke points of the Indian Ocean. 7. What should Japan do?

Approach: Deliver real-time radar data and establish humanitarian medical corridors.

8. What role does Australia play?

Approach: Long-range fuel shipments, major multilateral diplomatic statements.

9. How to protect the semiconductor foundries (TSMC)?

Method: Defend facilities with air defence batteries. Prioritise emergency power. 10. How to combat viral deepfakes and fake surrender news?

Method: National Security Bureau rapid fact-check alerts aired on all public channels. 11. How to fan the crisis and get away with it?

Approach: Highlight defensive proportionality; refrain from unprovoked firing across the median line. 12. What occurs when natural gas reserves fall below 5 days?

Approach: Move industrial power grids to coal/oil reserves, prioritise hospitals/water plants. 13. How to keep open cross-Strait emergency hotlines?

Approach: Use neutral third-party diplomatic envoys (e.g. Singapore or Switzerland).

14. But what if Beijing offers a conditional ceasefire?

Approach: Scrutinise terms; insist on lifting of naval cordons before talks. 15. How to defend centers of the civil population against air threats?

Approach: Provide verified underground civil defence shelters. Activate public early-warning sirens.

12. BIBLIOGRAPHY

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